

*Fig. 28.3.* The universe above, surrounded by the accretion disk, as seen by Cooper inside Gargantua, looking upward across his Ranger's fuselage. Gargantua's shadow is the black region on the left. *[From* Interstellar*, used courtesy of Warner Bros. Entertainment Inc.]*

Cooper can also overtake stuff that's infalling more slowly than he. This may explain the white flakes that hit and bounce off his Ranger in the movie.

## Rescued by the Tesseract

In my science interpretation, as the Ranger nears the outflying singularity, it encounters mounting tidal forces. Cooper ejects just in the nick of time. Tidal forces tear the Ranger apart. Visually, it splits in two.

At the singularity's edge the tesseract awaits Cooper—placed there, presumably, by bulk beings (Figure 28.4).